City of Cambridge

RES 2026-132
FIRST IN COUNCIL
September 28, 2026

COUNCILLOR SIMMONS

WHEREAS: Marvin E. Gilmore, Jr. has long been a cherished member of the Cambridge and Greater Boston communities, devoting his extraordinary life to expanding opportunity, advancing equality, and opening doors for others; and

WHEREAS: Mr. Gilmore was born on September 23, 1924, and recently celebrated his 102nd birthday, an occasion to celebrate both a long and richly lived life and the generations of people who have benefited from his service, leadership, and friendship; and

WHEREAS: Mr. Gilmore served honorably during World War II as a member of the 458th Anti-Aircraft Artillery Battalion, helping to liberate Europe while confronting the segregation and discrimination faced by Black servicemen in his own country; and

WHEREAS: Following his military service, Mr. Gilmore continued his work to build a more just society, co-founding Unity Bank and Trust Company, the first Black-owned and operated commercial bank in New England, and helping to expand access to capital and economic opportunity for communities too often denied both; and

WHEREAS: Throughout his distinguished life, Mr. Gilmore has brought determination, generosity, and vision to his roles as an entrepreneur, advocate, mentor, and community leader, encouraging others to pursue their ambitions and helping them find the means to do so; and

WHEREAS: His contributions have touched the lives of entrepreneurs, veterans, artists, activists, and young people, and his example continues to remind us of what one person can accomplish through courage, persistence, and a lasting commitment to the well-being of others; and

WHEREAS: Mr. Gilmore gathered with family and friends at La Fabrica Restaurant in Central Square on September 27, 2026 to commemorate his 102nd trip around the sun, surrounded by those whose lives he has enriched and who hold him in great affection and esteem; and

WHEREAS: The Cambridge City Council is pleased to join his loved ones and the broader community in celebrating this extraordinary milestone and expressing its gratitude for his many decades of service; now therefore be it

RESOLVED: That the City Council go on record extending its deepest admiration, heartfelt gratitude, and warmest birthday wishes to **Marvin E. Gilmore, Jr.** on the occasion of his **102nd birthday**, with every wish for continued happiness, good health, and the company of family and friends; and be it further

RESOLVED: That the City Clerk be and hereby is requested to forward a suitably engrossed copy of this resolution to **Mr. Marvin Gilmore** on behalf of the entire City Council.

A true copy;

ATTEST:-

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk

City of Cambridge

Happy 102nd Birthday to Marvin Gilmore.